

BPW Lightroom Plugins

Setup & Troubleshooting Guide

This guide covers everything you need to get started with the Belfast Photo Workshops Lightroom plugins. There are two ways to install — the Bundle Installer (recommended) or individual plugin zips.

Option A — Bundle Installer (Recommended)

Installs all three plugins in one go. Python is included — nothing else to install.

1 Download BPW Plugin Installer.zip from the BPW website.

2 Unzip the file.

Double-click the zip. A folder containing the installer will appear.

Note: Do not drag the .app out of this folder before running it — it must stay in the same folder as the other files.

3 Double-click BPW Plugin Installer.app to run it.

If macOS says it cannot be opened, right-click the .app and choose Open, then click Open in the dialog.

4 Work through the installer screens and click Install.

5 When you see Installation Complete, click Finish.

6 Open Lightroom Classic. Go to File > Plug-in Manager.

Click Add, navigate to ~/LightroomAI/ (your home folder > LightroomAI), and add each .lrplugin folder one at a time. Each should show a green dot. Click Done.

7 Run any plugin from Library > Plug-in Extras.

On first run, KeywordAI and IPTCFiller will ask for your Anthropic API key and your name and copyright notice. These are saved automatically for all future runs.

Option B — Individual Plugin Zips

Download only the plugins you need. Python is bundled inside — nothing else to install.

1 Download the zip for the plugin you want from the BPW website.

2 Unzip the file.

You will see a folder containing the .lrplugin folder and some other files including python.tar.gz. This is normal — leave everything as is.

Note: Do not move the .lrplugin folder out of the unzipped folder on its own. The plugin needs all the files in the folder to work correctly.

3 Move the entire unzipped folder to a permanent location.

A good place is your Documents folder or home folder. Do not keep it in Downloads as you may accidentally delete it.

4 Open Lightroom Classic. Go to File > Plug-in Manager.

5 Click Add and navigate into your unzipped folder.

Select the .lrplugin folder inside it and click Add Plug-in. It should show a green dot. Click Done.

6 Run the plugin from Library > Plug-in Extras.

On first run, KeywordAI and IPTCFiller will ask for your Anthropic API key. IPTCFiller will also ask for your name and copyright notice. These are saved automatically for all future runs.

Getting Your Anthropic API Key

KeywordAI and IPTCFiller require a free Anthropic account and a small amount of API credit. CopyrightHelper does not need this.

1 Go to console.anthropic.com and create a free account.

2 Click API Keys in the left sidebar, then Create Key.

Give it a name like 'Lightroom Plugins'. Copy the key — it starts with sk-ant-

3 Go to Plans & Billing and add at least \$5 of credit.

Running cost is approximately \$0.01 per photo. \$5 covers hundreds of photos. There is no subscription.

4 Paste the key into the plugin dialog when prompted on first run.

Using the Plugins

KeywordAI

Suggests up to 30 relevant keywords for your selected photos. Select one or more photos in Lightroom, then go to Library > Plug-in Extras > KeywordAI.

Two modes:

Suggest Keywords (Review and Select) — shows suggested keywords for each photo. Tick the ones you want and click Apply.

Suggest Keywords (Auto, No Prompts) — applies all keywords automatically with no interruptions. Best for batches.

IPTCFiller

Fills IPTC metadata fields including title, caption, keywords, location, creator, and copyright. Select one or more photos, then go to Library > Plug-in Extras > Fill IPTC Metadata with AI.

Two modes are available from Library > Plug-in Extras:

Fill IPTC Metadata with AI (Review & Select) — check and confirm each field before applying.

Fill IPTC Metadata with AI (Auto, No Prompts) — fills all fields instantly with no interruptions.

Copyright Helper

Guides you through registering photos with the US Copyright Office eCO system. No API key or internet connection required — runs entirely within Lightroom.

You will need a free eCO account at copyright.gov/eco and a filing fee of \$55 for a group of up to 750 photographs.

Common Questions

Q: macOS says the installer or plugin cannot be opened.

Right-click the file and choose Open, then click Open in the dialog that appears. This is a one-time step required for software downloaded outside the App Store.

Q: The plugin shows a red dot or grey dot in Plugin Manager.

The plugin file may have moved or been deleted. Click Remove, then Add again and navigate to the correct .lrplugin folder in its original location.

Q: I get 'No keywords returned' or 'No data returned'.

Check your Anthropic API key is correct and your account has credit remaining at console.anthropic.com. Make sure at least one photo is selected before running the plugin.

Q: I get 'ERROR_AUTH: Your Anthropic API key is invalid or expired'.

Your saved API key is wrong or has been revoked. In Finder, go to your home folder > LightroomAI and delete api_key.txt. Run the plugin again to enter a new key.

Q: My name and copyright are not appearing in the metadata.

In Finder, go to your home folder > LightroomAI and delete photographer.txt. Run the plugin again and you will be prompted to re-enter your details.

Q: How do I find my home folder in Finder?

Open Finder, click Go in the menu bar, then hold the Option key — your home folder appears in the list. Alternatively press Cmd+Shift+G and type ~/LightroomAI/

Q: The plugin stopped working after a Lightroom or macOS update.

Open Lightroom, go to File > Plug-in Manager, find the affected plugin and check it still shows a green dot. If not, click Remove and re-add it by navigating to the .lrplugin folder.

Q: I moved my plugins folder and now they do not work.

For individual plugins, go to File > Plug-in Manager, remove the plugin, and re-add it from its new location. For the bundle installer, the plugins are stored in ~/LightroomAI/ and should not be moved.

Q: The plugin is very slow.

Each photo takes 5-15 seconds. This is normal. For large batches use Auto mode so you are not interrupted between photos. Make sure you have a stable internet connection.

Q: Do I need an internet connection?

Yes, for KeywordAI and IPTCFiller. They send your photo to the Anthropic API for analysis. CopyrightHelper works offline.

Q: Will this work on Windows?

Windows support is coming soon. Currently the plugins require a Mac with Apple Silicon (M1, M2, M3, or M4).

Q: How much does it cost to run?

Approximately \$0.01 or less per photo. \$5 of Anthropic credit covers hundreds of photos. You only pay for what you use — there is no subscription.

